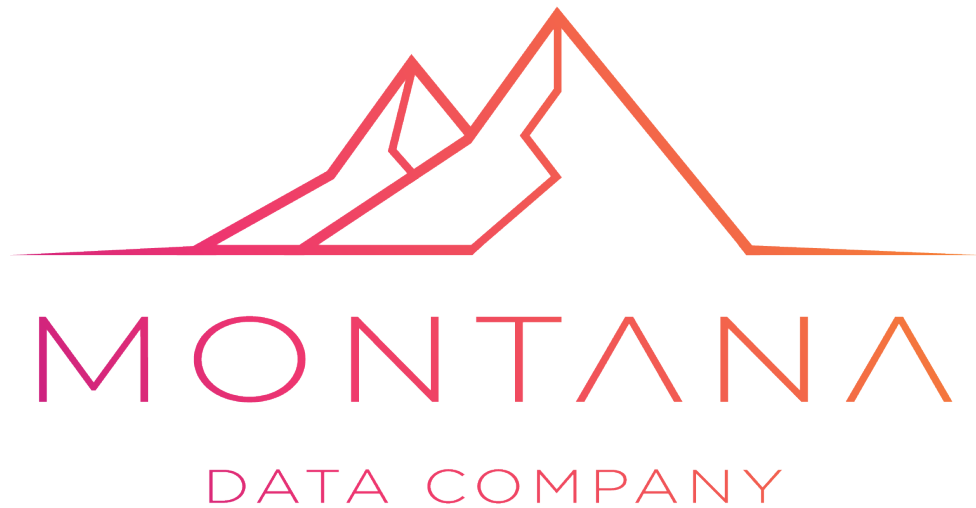




RANSOMWARE RESPONSE PLAYBOOK - SHORT

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Purpose of This Playbook

The First 72 Hours After a Ransomware Attack: A Decision-Tree Framework for IT Teams and Business Continuity Managers.

This document helps IT teams, security teams, business continuity managers, and executive leadership respond decisively during the first 72 hours following a ransomware incident.

Core Principles

1. Preserve evidence.
2. Isolate affected systems.
3. Protect backups immediately.
4. Assume credentials are compromised.
5. Document every action taken.

Phase 1: First 15 Minutes

Objectives:

- Confirm the incident
- Prevent further spread
- Protect critical infrastructure
- Activate response procedures

Immediate Actions

- Isolate infected systems
- Disable compromised accounts
- Protect backup infrastructure
- Activate the incident response team

Phase 2: First Hour

Establish secure communications, determine scope of compromise, and preserve forensic evidence.

Phase 3: Hours 1–6

Assess operational impact, identify critical systems, and evaluate data exfiltration risks.

Phase 4: Hours 6–24

Identify attack vectors, assess identity infrastructure compromise, and prepare recovery plans.

Phase 5: Hours 24–48

Build clean recovery environments and begin phased restoration of critical systems.

Phase 6: Hours 48–72

Stabilize operations, assess regulatory obligations, and implement stakeholder communication plans.

Decision Tree Framework

Ransomware Detected
|
+-- Is encryption spreading?
|
+-- YES -> Immediate containment and segmentation
+-- NO -> Isolate affected systems and preserve evidence

Recovery Readiness Checklist

- ☐ Attack vector identified
- ☐ Persistence mechanisms removed
- ☐ Credentials rotated
- ☐ Backup integrity validated
- ☐ Monitoring controls active

Executive Briefing Template

Date/time detected:
Systems impacted:
Business impact:
Backup status:
Estimated recovery timeline:

Post-Incident Review

Conduct a lessons-learned review covering attack entry methods, failed controls, response effectiveness, and required remediation improvements.

Contact Us

If you would like to discuss your organisation's specific requirements, risks, compliance obligations, cybersecurity posture, business continuity strategy, or operational resilience objectives in greater detail, we invite you to contact Montana Data Company.

Our team can assist with tailored assessments, strategic guidance, governance support, and practical implementation aligned to your organisation's unique operational and regulatory environment.

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